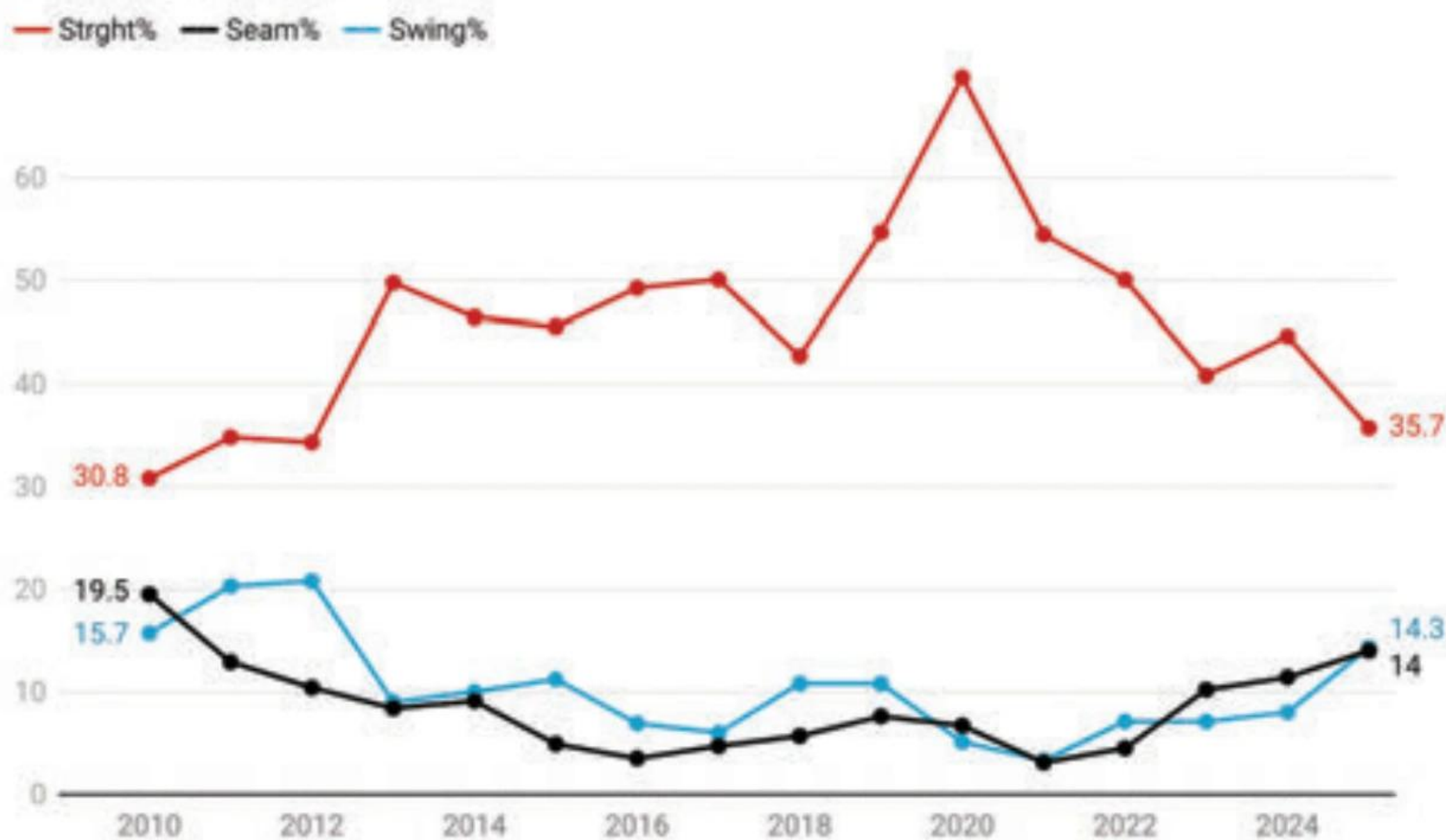


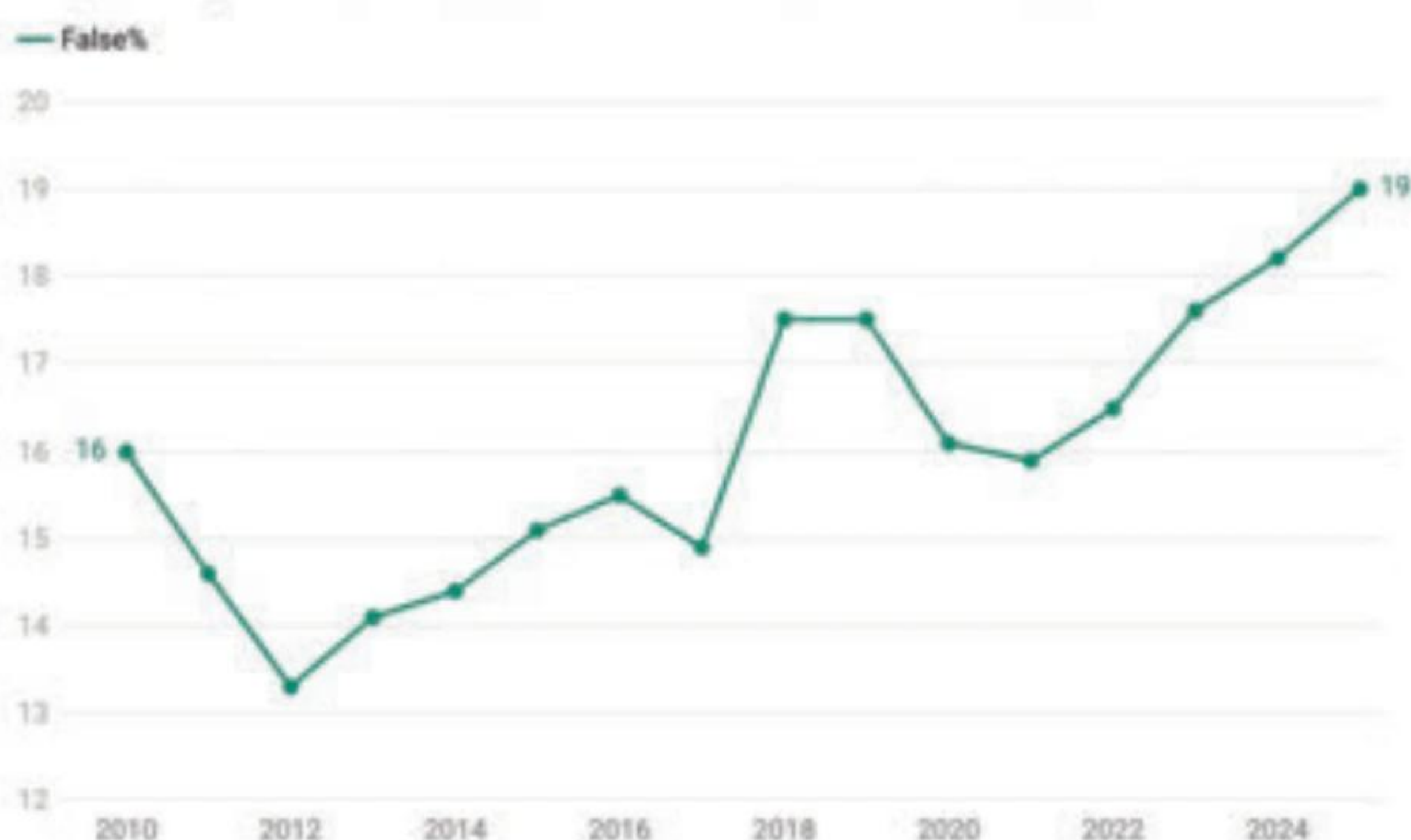
Percentage of straight, swing, and seam deliveries in overs 11-20

Since 2010, the percentage of straight deliveries has dropped, while the percentage of swinging and seaming deliveries has increased.



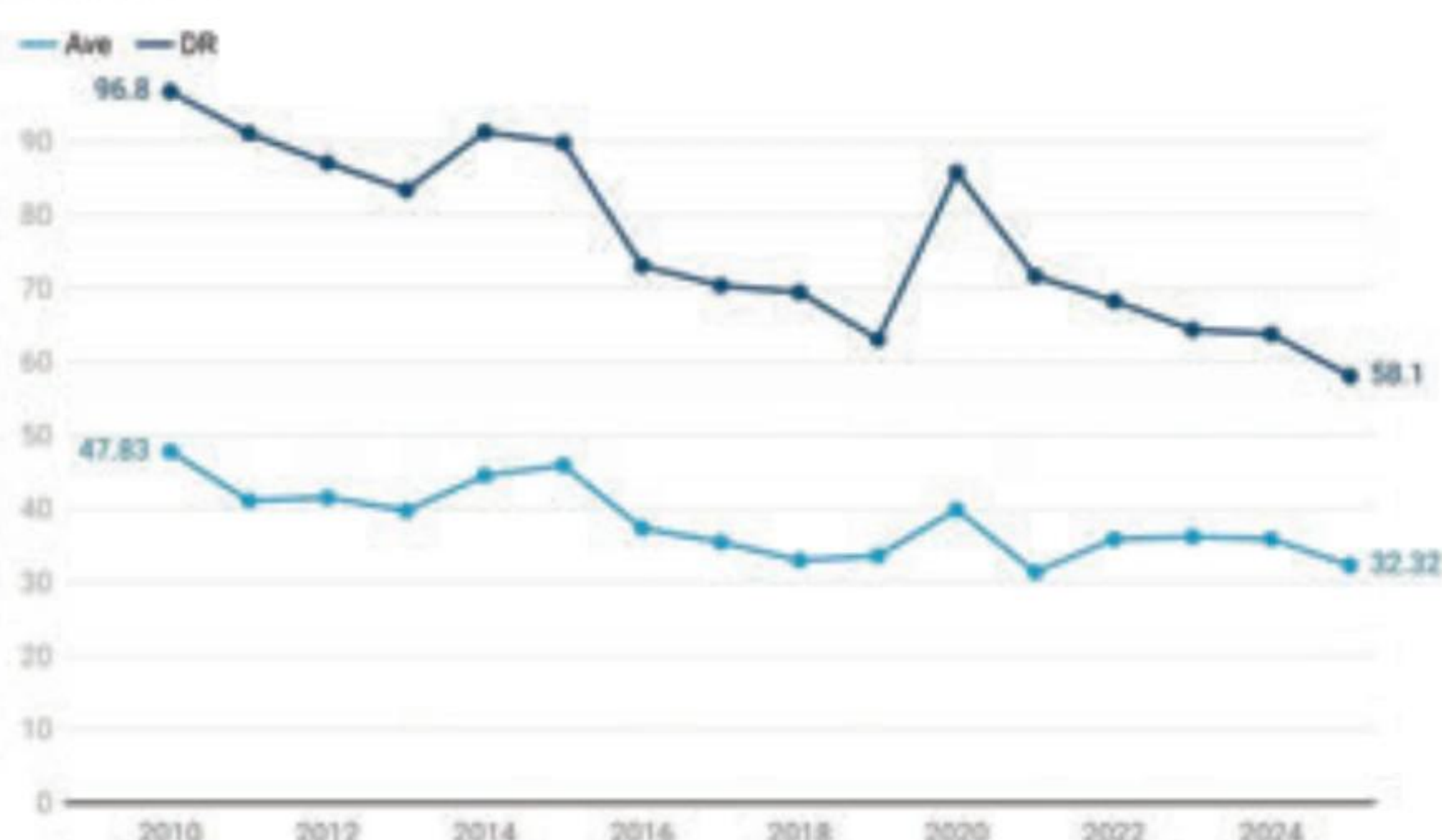
Percentage of false shots in overs 11-20

The percentage of false shots in overs 11-20 has been on the rise since 2010.



Batting average and dismissal rate for no. 3s since 2010

The batting average and balls per dismissal have both been on the decline for number 3 batters since 2010.



heavyweights, or just promoting whoever is next in line. That lack of clarity may reflect confusion about what number 3 even demands in modern Test cricket.

India, for instance, has used five different batters at No. 3 since the start of the 2024-25

Border-Gavaskar Trophy: Devdutt Padikkal, Shubman Gill, KL Rahul, B Sai Sudharsan, and Karun Nair. Of those, only Sudharsan has crossed the 50-mark, with a score of 61 in Manchester.

This instability is made worse by timing. Since 2019, the average dismissal rate for openers in WTC games is 64.3 balls — just shy of 11 overs. In the 2023-25 cycle, that's down to 54 balls (roughly 9 overs). Number 3s now often walk in during one of the toughest phases of the game — overs 11 to 20.

So, the modern number 3 faces a double bind: often inexperienced or out of position, and forced to begin the innings just as batting becomes more difficult.

Perhaps the real question isn't who wants to be number 3 — but who'd still dare to be one?

(Numbers accurate to July 12)